

POCO F6

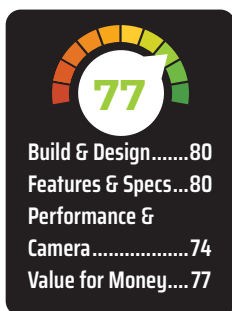
More than just a gaming powerhouse

When POCO exploded onto the smartphone scene in 2018, it redefined value with the iconic POCO F1, setting a new benchmark for the price-to-performance ratio. Since then, the brand hasn't quite delivered another shocker like the POCO F1. But now, with the launch of the POCO F6, it seems POCO is returning to its roots, offering a flagship-grade processor and exceptional performance at a remarkably reasonable price. The POCO F6 is the first phone in India to feature the new Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, promising top-tier performance.

Back in 2018, the POCO F1 was the undisputed champion of performance in its price range. Fast forward to today, the POCO F6 faces a formidable rival – the iQOO Neo 9 Pro. This competitor is so powerful that it has outperformed some flagship phones, making the competition even fiercer. At the time of writing, the exact price of the POCO F6 remains unconfirmed, but leaks suggest it could be priced under ₹35,000. With this in mind, let's dive into my detailed review of the POCO F6 to address the all-important question – should you buy this phone, or are there better options on the market worth considering?

BUILD AND DESIGN

The POCO F6 embraces a minimalist aesthetic, featuring subtle design choices and understated colours. Available in Titanium and Black, the Titanium variant, in particular, radiates a touch of elegance and sophistication. Despite this, a group of gamers – fans of the bold, gamer-centric look of the POCO F3 GT – found the new design underwhelming. Clearly, the POCO F6's design doesn't cater to the gaming crowd's flashy tastes. The rear panel of the phone sports a



matte finish, effectively resisting fingerprints and smudges. The dual camera setup is neatly housed in two large, circular modules on the left side, complemented by a ring flash system adjacent to the cameras. While the back is crafted from polycarbonate, the frame is a hybrid of polycarbonate and metal, according to POCO.

Weighing in at just 179 grams, the POCO F6 is delightfully lightweight and comfortable to hold, thanks to the subtle curvature of the back panel that enhances its ergonomic feel. With a svelte thickness of just 7.8 mm, it's also impressively slim.

Though the buttons are a tad softer than preferred, they function adequately, and the in-display fingerprint sensor is both fast and accurate. The phone boasts a stereo speaker setup with Dolby Atmos support, delivering sufficiently loud and decent sound quality. Moreover, the POCO F6 carries an IP64 rating, ensuring protection against environmental elements and resilience to light splashes.

DISPLAY

The POCO F6 has a stunning display, framed by impressively slim bezels. This 6.67-inch AMOLED panel boasts a 1.5K resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate, creating an outstanding experience for content consumption. Adding to its allure, the display supports HDR10+ and Dolby Vision, complemented by stereo speakers for an immersive viewing experience.

This 12-bit panel, capable of showcasing 68 billion colours, covers 100 per cent of the DCI-P3 colour gamut, ensuring vibrant visuals. Topping it off, the display is protected by Gorilla Glass Victus, a rare and valuable feature at this price point.

The POCO F6's display is not just vibrant but exceptionally crisp, with deep blacks and excellent contrast levels that make HDR content shine. Its brightness peaks at an impressive 2,400 nits, as claimed by POCO, and in my tests, it reached 1,078 nits under direct sunlight in Auto Brightness mode – more than enough to ensure readability even on the sunniest days. In the realm of content consumption under ₹40K, this display stands out as one of the best. While the iQOO Neo9 Pro offers an LTPO panel, giving it a slight edge, it lacks Dolby Atmos support and features a 10-bit display compared to the superior 12-bit panel on the POCO F6.

PERFORMANCE

During a media briefing for the POCO F6, the company emphasized their ambition for the POCO F6 to transcend its gaming phone roots and become a well-rounded smartphone. Despite this broader focus, the POCO F6 retains the core elements of a high-performance gaming device: a flagship-grade processor, robust cooling system, and the latest RAM and storage technologies.

Under the hood, the POCO F6 features the cutting-edge Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 processor, paired with up to 12 GB of LPDDR5X RAM and up to 512 GB of UFS 4.0 storage. However, the absence of expandable storage is a letdown, particularly for gamers with storage-intensive titles like Genshin Impact, which can take up nearly 22 GB. The device also includes POCO's Wildboost 3.0 technology